THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

MACC 7027 Special Topics in Financial Reporting

GENERAL INFORMATION

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COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course is designed to provide in-depth knowledge of advanced accounting topics relevant to students aiming to enhance their technical knowledge in financial reporting. We will explore complex issues in group accounting, including reverse acquisitions, changes in group structures, and the consolidation of foreign operations. Additionally, the course will cover contemporary and emerging topics such as accounting for insurance contracts, fair value measurement, and digital assets. To facilitate practical understanding, the course will incorporate numerous case studies and real-world examples, enabling students to effectively apply International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS). Industry professionals will also deliver guest lectures, offering valuable insights from the field. Active participation in class discussions and activities is highly encouraged to maximize learning.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

1. To equip students with comprehensive knowledge and sophisticated techniques in financial reporting, including consolidation accounting for complex business group structures and the application of relevant IFRS for specialized transactions.
2. To enhance students' ability to analyze and utilize financial accounting information across diverse decision-making contexts.
3. To foster students' awareness of ethical considerations and professional integrity in financial reporting.
4. To provide students with a global perspective on the accounting profession, emphasizing international standards and practices.

5. To cultivate students' leadership and communication skills through collaborative teamwork and interactive activities.

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO1: Acquiring and internalizing accounting and business knowledge and skills
PLO2: Applying and integrating accounting and business knowledge
PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership
PLO4: Developing a global outlook
PLO5: Mastering communication skills

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Course Learning Outcomes	Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes
CLO1. Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of specialized financial reporting topics and issues;	PLO1
CLO2. Application and integration of financial accounting information in different decision-making scenarios for both profit and non-profit organizations;	PLO2
CLO3. Identification of ethical issues in financial reporting;	PLO3
CLO4. Development of global outlook in the accounting profession;	PLO4
CLO5. Development of leadership skills and communications skills through team work.	PLO3, 5

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	Expected Hour	Study Load (% of study)
T&L1. Interactive Lectures	30	25%
T&L2. Take-Home Assignments and Consultations	30	25%
T&L3. Group Project	30	25%
T&L4. Lecture Preparation & Self-Study	30	25%
Total	120	100%

Assessment Methods	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1. In-class participation	10%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
A2. Assignments	30%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
A3. Group project presentation	20%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
A4. Final exam	40%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
Total	100%	

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT	
Course Grade Descriptors	
A+, A, A-	・Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Handling questions professionally ・High participation in discussions ・Present arguments that have an element of originality ・Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the exams with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills ・Excellent performance in assignments
B+, B, B-	・Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Handling questions in a logical way ・Good participation in discussions ・Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook ・Achieve a standard of good performance in the exams with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills ・Good performance in assignments
C+, C, C-	・Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved ・Fairly address questions as set ・Some participation in discussions ・Present arguments in a well-structure manner ・Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the exams with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills ・Acceptable performance in assignments
D+, D	・Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved ・Barely address questions as set ・Minimal or no participation in discussions ・Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner ・Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the exams with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills ・Marginally acceptable performance in assignments
F	・Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved ・Unable or unwilling to handle questions ・Minimal or no participation in discussions ・Present arguments poorly ・Fail to meet a standard of passing the exams with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills ・Poorly performance in assignments
Assessment Rubrics for Participation	
A+, A, A-	・High participation in discussions ・Always attend in-class discussions ・Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Handling questions professionally ・Present arguments that have an element of originality ・Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
B+, B, B-	・Good participation in discussions ・Often attend in-class discussions ・Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Handling questions in a logical way ・Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook ・Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
C+, C, C-	・Some participation in discussions ・Sometimes attend in-class discussions

	・Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved ・Fairly address questions as set ・Present arguments in a well-structure manner ・Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
D+, D	・Minimal or no participation in discussions ・Rarely attend in-class discussions ・Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved ・Barely address questions as set ・Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner ・Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
F	・Minimal or no participation in discussions ・Almost never attend in-class discussions ・Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved ・Unable or unwilling to handle questions ・Present arguments poorly ・Behave poorly in class (often chatting with others, using cell phones, or being late)
Assessment Rubrics for Group Project Presentation	
A+, A, A-	• The presentation was highly successful at communicating the essential elements of the topic to the audience. • Concepts were thoroughly explained and clarified. • The presentation demonstrated deep understanding and comprehension of the topic. • There was clear evidence of independent thought and reflection on the topic. • The topic was covered in a highly professional and organized manner. • The presenter displayed excellent verbal skills and delivered a highly interesting, coherent presentation at an appropriate level for the audience.
B+, B, B-	• The presentation was successful at communicating the essential elements of the topic to the audience. • Most concepts were well explained and clarified. • The presentation demonstrated sound understanding and comprehension of most aspects of the topic. • The topic was covered in a professional and organized manner. • The presenter displayed good verbal skills and mostly delivered an interesting, coherent presentation at an appropriate level for the audience.
C+, C, C-	• The presentation adequately communicated most of the essential elements of the topic to the audience. • Most concepts were adequately explained. • The presentation demonstrated good understanding and comprehension of most aspects of the topic. • The topic was covered in an organized manner. • The presenter displayed adequate verbal skills and delivered a mostly coherent presentation at an appropriate level for the audience.
D+, D	• The presentation basically covered the main aspects of the topic. • The presentation demonstrated basic understanding and comprehension of most of the topic. • The topic was covered in a basic manner. • The presenter displayed minimal standards of verbal skills and or coherence and organization.
F	• The presentation was poorly addressed and or concepts were inadequately explained. • The presentation did not demonstrate sufficient understanding and comprehension of the topic. • The topic was not covered acceptably and or was poorly organized. Verbal skills were inadequate.
Assessment Rubrics for Assignments and the Exam	
A+, A, A-	・Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Present arguments that have an element of originality

	• Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the assessments with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills
B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Achieve a standard of good performance in the assessments with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the assessments with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills
D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the assessments with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the assessments with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

Teaching schedule:

Lecture	Course Content
1	Group accounting: reverse acquisitions and complex group structures
2	Group accounting: changes in group structures
3	Group accounting: consolidated statement of cash flows
4	Group accounting: financial analysis for business groups
5	Group accounting: related party disclosures and translation of foreign financial statements
6	Accounting for Insurance Contracts (IFRS 16)
7	Fair value measurement (IFRS 13)
8	**Case Discussion:** Accounting of Stablecoin: Impact on Corporate Crypto Strategy
9	**Guest Lecture:** Accounting for digital assets and cryptocurrencies
10	**Group project presentations**

Assignments (take home and in-class) and Final exam will cover Lecture 1 to 7.

In-class participation marks will be taken in Lecture 8 to 10.

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS

Course Website: HKU Moodle “MACC7027 Special Topics in Financial Reporting”

Reference Book: Picker et al. Applying IFRS Standards, EY & Wiley.

COURSE POLICY

An orderly learning environment is extremely important for this course. Disruptive behaviors are absolutely unacceptable. Academic dishonesty includes cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, falsifying academic records, and any act designed to avoid participating honestly in the learning process. Any such dishonesty will result in an F grade.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION

Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded on Moodle.
No late assignments will be accepted.